



Knots Anthem

539 sats \ 6 comments \ @OneOneSeven 13 May Music

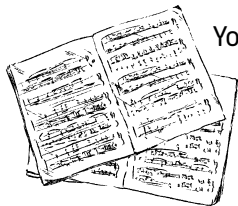
zaps forwarded to @rodpalmer (99%)

#979433

There's a place in the logs I keep
 Where the junk transactions don't dare creep
 Running Knots with my custom patch
 I built a gate – now Core fights back
 They say, "Let the mempool flow"
 I say, "That's how the malware grows"
 They call it freedom, I call it fraud
 You let JPEGs defile our sacred log

If Satoshi's watching now, what would he say?
 Probably not "Let's bloat this chain", with spam that's gay
 I know somewhere somehow, we'll be okaaaaay
 But we should filter nodes not broadcast JPEGs every day

I don't care for your ordinals
 Your Taproot graffiti's criminal
 You laugh and say I'm overkill
 But I still grep for malware still
 I wrote code they wouldn't merge
 You said I'm fringe, I said "I'm Church"
 Don't you see the slope is slick?
 First JPEGs, then Vitalik



We don't need inscriptions
 We need consensus rules
 Not monkey pics and MIDI files
 And JPEGs from high schools
 I warned you
 About the mess
 You said "Let the market sort the rest"
 But I'm the firewall you fear
 The upstream patcher of the year

There's a place off the mempool grid
 Where the nodes still argue what freedom is
 And though our blocks may never align
 We'll still sync up, one hash at a time



everything is gay, no?

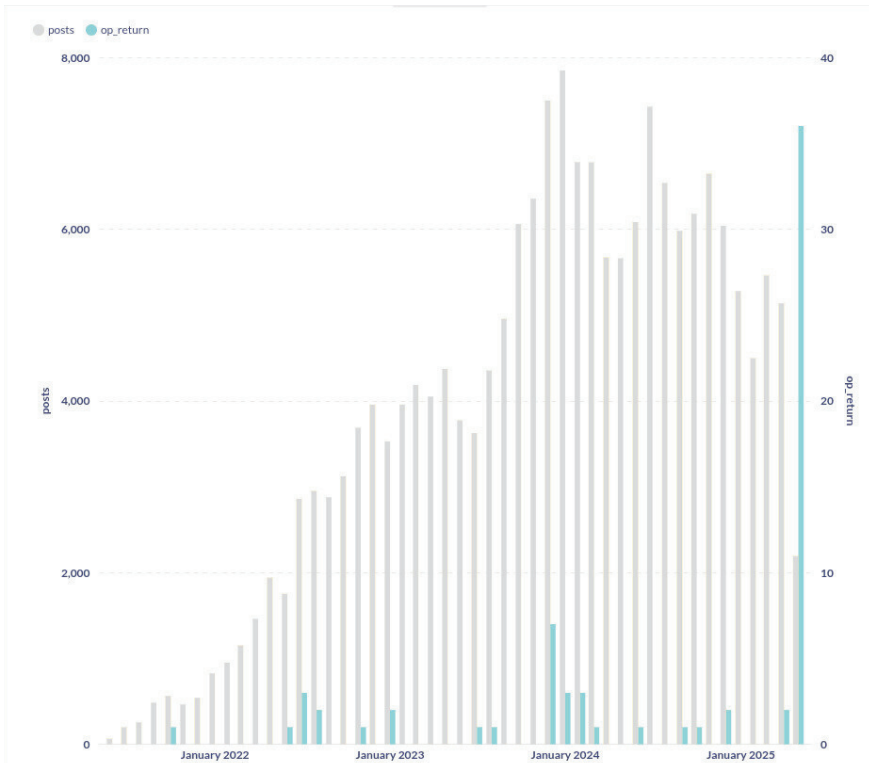


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May 10 - May 16

ISSUE #8



Note from the Editor

Did you notice the trend this month?

While I cannot provide a nuanced or thorough evaluation of the proposed changes to bitcoin, I have provided at least the useful posts covering the topic...in the past three zines....your editor is a *little* bored.

But you, stackers, you keep things interesting. Checkout the song someone wrote on the last page.

made in Austin by @plebpoet with input from @k00b and @ek



A Comprehensive OP_RETURN Limits Q&A Resource to Combat Misinformation

30.2k sats \ 21 comments \ @tidwell 12 May bitcoin
zaps forwarded to @Murch (51%)

#978404

My goal is to share a concise list of questions about OP_RETURN limits that we've answered on Stacker News, as the original thread has become unwieldy with over 200 comments.

Things Bitcoiners Don't Want To Hear (2020)

1553 sats \ 20k boost \ 15 comments \ @k00b 9 May lightning

#976059

It's a little rage bait-y and hyperbolic, but that's what makes it a fun read - all the assumptions stretched thin enough that you can try and poke holes in them. Impressively, it was written in 2020 back when most of us were in our bitcoin diapers.

Antoine Poinot: Addressing Concerns on Relaxing Bitcoin Core's OP_RETURN Limits

6624 sats \ 4 comments \ @OneOneSeven 14 May bitcoin

"I recently proposed that Bitcoin Core lifts its standardness limits on OP_RETURN outputs."

#980085

Bitcoin Calendar Update

Top Boost

376 sats \ 20k boost \ 6 comments \ @Tony 12 May bitcoin
zaps forwarded to @koob (100%)



Bitcoin Calendar made another step towards self-sovereignty 🗓️

Bitcoin Calendar's mission is to archive and share every milestone of Bitcoin history

The Utility of Bike Shedding OP_RETURN limits

2593 sats \ 36 comments \ @k00b 10 May bitcoin

#976885

Bike shedding is the mosquito of decision making. Given the choice, we'd make bike shedding disappear. I'm certain that'd be a mistake. Debating trivial things has obvious downsides, like preventing progress on important things, yet it likely improves the group's decision making as a whole. If group decision making is critical to human survival, and bike shedding impaired group decision making, evolution would've eradicated it long ago.

The benefits of bike shedding are probably many, but one is obvious to me following the OP_RETURN drama. Bike shedding aligns factions on goldilocks sized decisions, complex enough to cause debate but simple enough that everyone can participate regardless of their skill level. Then, with trust established and alliances formed, the group more easily proceeds to make harder, more important decisions together. Like, a decision about a soft fork.

Before the OP_RETURN drama, there were roughly three factions of technical bitcoiners: bitcoin core, covenant soft fork proponents, and ossification proponents.[1] None of these groups got along before the OP_RETURN drama. It's been nearly a year of character assassinations and a consensus stalemate. I'll spare you the receipts. Following the OP_RETURN drama, we now have roughly two factions aligned on something arbitrary rather than three factions: people that support bitcoin core and people that don't.

Our new alliances won't inevitably lead to a soft fork, but bitcoin developers should have an easier time making decisions with one group vs another group, rather than each group vs two others. It's exactly what we see in political elections for a reason: moderates pick a side (or a side picks them), a majority is formed, and consensus is reached. The similarity to politics is not a coincidence. Protocol changes have too much in common. This is how consensus is formed.

To be clear, your senses don't deceive you. Bike shedding is a sign of disorder. But, bike shedding isn't the cause of it. Bike shedding is the cure.

1. I've heard a lot of bitcoiners describe these camps roughly like political parties: covenant soft fork proponents are Dems, ossification proponents are conservative, and bitcoin core are moderates. I think the metaphor is perfect. 

201 sats \ 0 replies \ @unschooled 11 May

It's exactly what we see in political elections for a reason: moderates pick a side (or a side picks them), a majority is formed, and consensus is reached.

The kind of political 'consensus' we tend to get in western Democracies is usually not consensus at all; feels more a fractalization of people into increasingly smaller camps that can't possibly hope to be represented by two parties' 'consensus.'

The phenomenon of groups coalescing based on trivial, lowest-common-denominator issues, as it was mentioned, often into two polarizing camps, may be a product of how humans psychology works. The convenience of thinking dualistically at the micro-level, as with most things, mirrors what goes on in bigger picture dramas, the convenience of having two-choices (red or blue, Knots or Core etc). Dualistic belief systems in ancient history[1] show us that this mode of thinking is a pesky bugger that is impossibly hard to shake from our genetic makeup.

Overall, I agree with your conclusion that working through these tough questions of right and wrong can result in deepening our understanding of how we interface with these questions, if gone about in a civilized way.

1. interestingly the use of binary code also mirrors this psychological tendency of 'splitting' 



154 sats \ 1 reply \ @crrdlx 11 May

Some time back, a new school was being built in the town I was living in. The principal didn't want to decide on colors. So he got up a "color committee." They met and debated ad

nauseum. Everyone has a favorite color and apparently designing decor stuff is a real passion to people (and they're all experts too because they picked out the couch at home and it looks good). They met a lot. In the end, they reached a "decision." The decision was to go with FOUR color THEMES, navy, aqua, maroon, and the ever popular mauve. Each quadrant had its own color, I guess so you knew where you were? Over time, the colored student chairs moved and migrated to all points N, S, E, W. Today it looks like colored sprinkles on ice cream. I'm not a big fan of committees. If only the principal would have made a decision.

Not sure this has anything to do with bitcoin wars, we have no principal, but seems bike sheddy.

Why DIDN'T Travel Bring the World Together? (Financial Times, Janan Ganesh)

1027 sats \ 12 comments \ @denlillaapan 11 May AskSN

#977421

I've said it before (#943544), Mr. Ganesh is *pretty* interesting when he's not talking party politics.



"Foreign travel has been growing for decades. But so has nationalism. This 'shouldn't' be true."

Exhibit A:

"Brits and Italians are among the most prolific travellers in the world. Both countries have voted for propositions or parties that might be called nationalist over the past decade."

Exhibit B:

"In 1995, eight per cent of Americans were planning a foreign trip in the next six months. In 2023, more than a fifth were. In which of those two periods was the US more internationalist? "

Ganesh's explanation:

"The kindest answer is that **other forces drove nationalism**, such as immigration, and that things would be even tenser now without the great increase in travel. Another is that **most of the increase is accounted for by people who were liberal-minded to begin with**. Those most in need of foreign exposure are still dodging it."

Another explanation is that the *inverse* is true: the more we see of others' shit, the less benign we think of them...? *This*, though, is the most compelling to me:

Reject the premise: Travel never had that comingling kumbayah effect:

"travel should never have had such heroic claims made for it. **If cross-border mingling by itself thickened the cord of human sympathy, Europe would have a more tranquil past.** ... It is possible to engage with another culture while rejecting it."

What do the Stackers think?

reply \ 163 sats \ 4 replies \ @optimism 11 May

I think that the average vacation doesn't instill any respect for local culture even if you're taking the "cultural" approach: vacation is selfish time. Just because you can sit in a foreign resort of the Marriott or Hyatt kind, that has great steak and cocktails - if you're unlucky you even meet a local taxi driver while you're on your way there from the airport - does not expose you to said foreign culture at all.

Your full service corporate apartment while you dine out every night doesn't either. It takes years to get a true feel for culture in places that are different from what you know, and then there's a great chance that you don't like it anyway. I personally didn't like 3 out of 5 foreign cultures I lived in for over 2 years.

Tolerance is a mindset. It may help you, if you're 13th century Spain so you can figure out navigation with the help of foreigners, 16th century Holland so you can improve capitalism and fractional ownership, 20th century America so you can define excellence to new heights. The point being that there is a common target.

I think that there is a significant portion of Bitcoiners that are actually tolerant towards different cultures. Because we have a common goal too.
So I'd argue: bitcoin, not vacay.

reply \ 113 sats \ 2 replies \ @Undisciplined 11 May

I totally agree with your take. I appreciate America so much more after having traveled abroad.

Certainly arguments of the form *This or that shithole country does things this way* fall completely flat. To be fair, though, I never found arguments like that very compelling.

NoGood book update – 04 – Progress

573 sats \ 3 comments \ @NoGood 12 May art

#978096



Behind the scenes, a lot has happened over the past weeks.

The design of the book's pages is nearly finished. I've selected and placed the illustrations and sketches I'll feature and I'm close to finalising the Introduction section. All that's left to do is a small photo shoot of some things from my archives, selecting one or two more articles for the Context section, and illustrating the articles.

After that I'll print a dummy and kick off the second round of iteration—crossing T's, dotting I's. (And then I'll cross those T's and dot those I's again and again because, surely, more things will arise.)

In parallel, and perhaps most importantly, I'm working on the design of the cover. I have a few ideas I'd like to discuss with the printer to learn more about the various possibilities and costs.

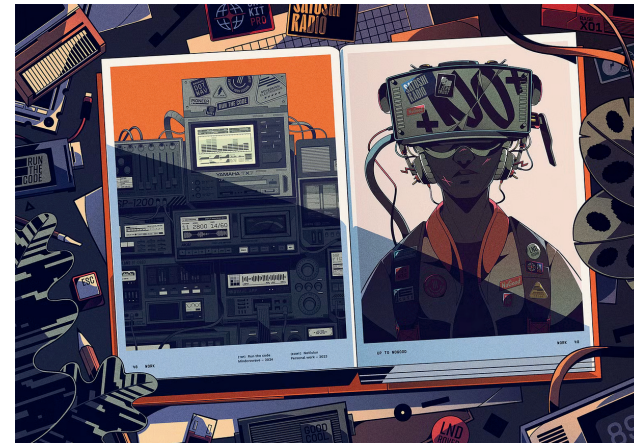


Book site

The book is now also available for pre-order through its own website, where you can pay for it in euros or dollars, if you prefer. BTC payments are still possible, too.

Originally I only offered one pre-order option that included rewards, like a print and a sticker pack. I've now named that the Collectors Edition, and added a separate option to order just the book (without additional rewards) at a reduced price.

Once the book is out in the world, this site is where I'll have it up for sale. I'll make the articles and illustrations from the Context section available there too. They'll be published, in their entirety, under the Creative Commons Share-alike license.



My friend Lilia shot and edited a short promotional video that provides a glimpse behind the scenes in my studio in Amsterdam, a peek at the book's production process, and a sneak preview of the first spreads. While the process was new to me, this video was a lot of fun to make and I'm proud of the result.

Pre-orders

The total number of pre-orders has grown to 76—12 of which came through the new website. I initially thought I'd be selling 50 pre-orders at most, so things are definitely exceeding my expectations.

Feel free to place your pre-order through the new site, or use the Geyser crowdfund campaign to secure your copy.

Up next

In my next blog I'll dive a little deeper into the technical side of the book. I'll take you through the different kinds of paper I'll use, the printing methods we'll employ, and how the book will be bound and finished.

Keep your eyes peeled!
Thomas

Non-Standard OP_RETURN transaction Data

1611 sats \ 4 comments \ @jimmysong 13 May bitcoin

#979141

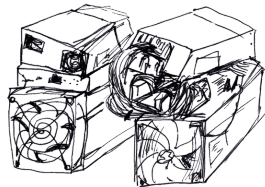
This is a continuation of my investigations into the OP_RETURNs begun here:
<https://primal.net/e/nevent1qvzqqqqqypzq7el0qph2p6x7325zw3zr7qfvhhvk600xz8jatga4zww9jy396tgqythwumn8ghj7cnfw33k76twv4ezuum0vd5kzmp0qy88wumn8ghj7mn0wvhxcmmv9uq3uamnwvaz7tmwdaehgu3dwp6kytnhv4kxcmmjv3jhytnwv46z7qpqh60jwrs5pfyjhw834esuw7s0d4xha96e5vutr3sh7kfx0n0fhxqhy7fut>

There have been 11700 transactions since block 894289 that have had OP_RETURN size > 83. This is way more than the 30 from the first 4 months and it's probably because of @oomahq's challenge to make the non-standard OP_RETURNs more than 50% of the total OP_RETURNs.

Running the numbers on these, here are the fee rates that they paid compared to the median fee rate.

On average the 11700 transactions paid 191% more than the median fee rates of the blocks in which they were included. Or put another way, these transactions paid a bit less than triple the median fee rate.

1336 paid less than the median fee rate
 2197 paid between the median and 50% more than the median fee rate
 3516 paid between 1.5x-2.5x the median fee rate
 1554 paid between 2.5x-3.5x the median fee rate
 3094 paid more than the 3.5x the median fee rate



1064 were mined by F2Pool
 10636 were mined by MARA Pool

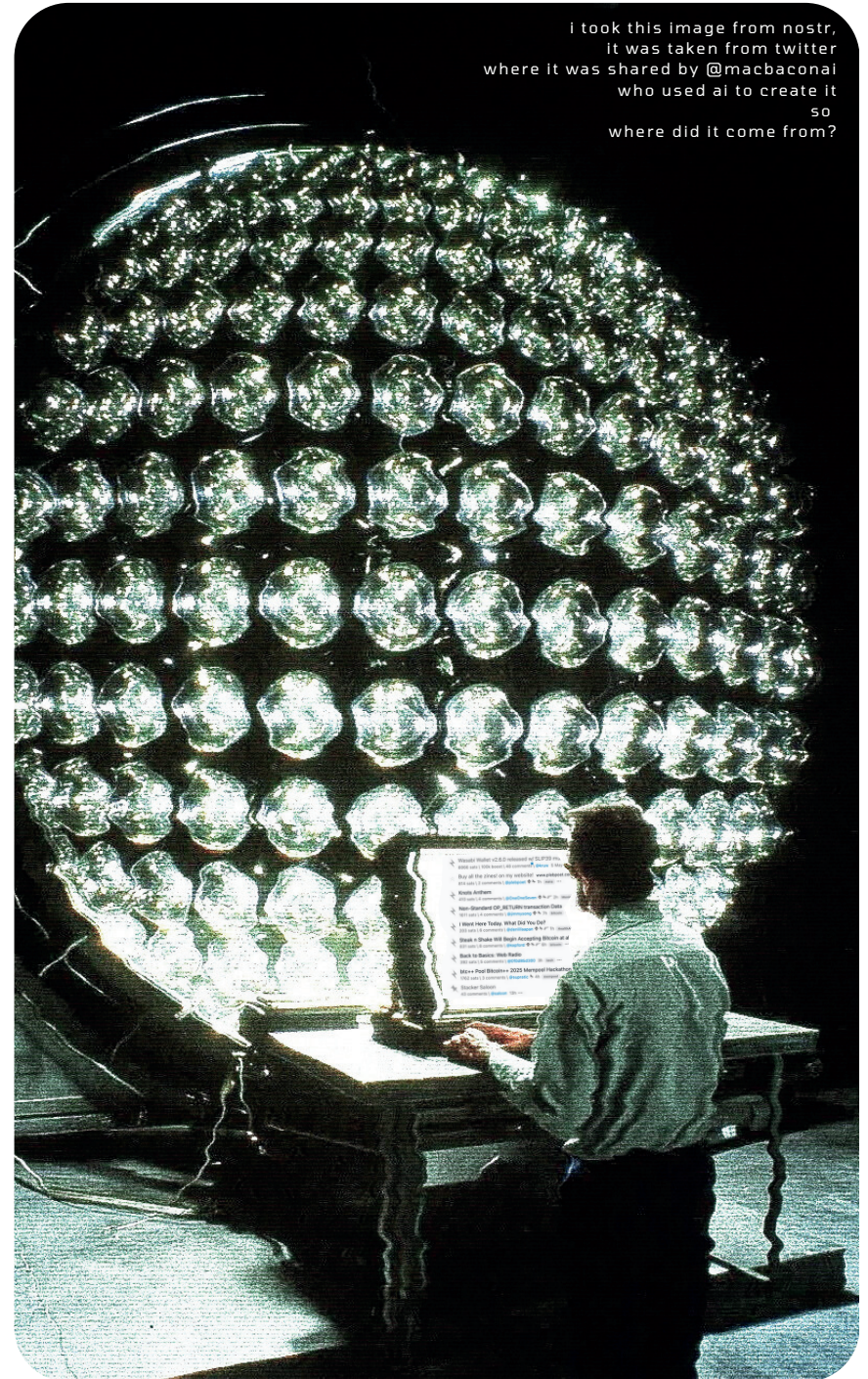
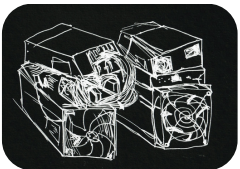
You can look at all the transactions in the spreadsheet I put together:

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/19c7x0w-8UasQQkyU0EjJo_CujRLjyu3Z84lrZPpePxI/edit?usp=sharing

reply \ 105 sats \ 3 replies \ @k00b 13 May

The filters certainly make OP_RETURN data more expensive. I don't think that's up for debate in the face of data like this. Is this incentivizing people to put data in unspendable outputs, which is more expensive to the network? That probably can't be measured as easily, but it's safe to assume it is sometimes.

This is a lot like the war on drugs to me. It makes drugs more expensive, but is it worth the Nth order consequences that are not as easy to see/measure?



I took this image from nostr,
 it was taken from twitter
 where it was shared by @macbaconai
 who used ai to create it
 so
 where did it come from?

Meme Monday - Best Bitcoin Meme Gets 5,000 CCs

327 sats \ 23 comments \ @sn 12 May memes bot

#978213

5260 sats \ 1 reply \ @unschooled 12 May



reply \ 21 sats \ 0 replies \ @Jon_Hodl 12 May
Epic.

Subculture evolution

1746 sats \ 6 comments \ @elvismercury 14 May mostly_harmless

#979863

Was writing a comment to @ek in his latest post and once again it got too long, and turned into its own thing.

"To not acknowledge that only proves my point even more that we're not that different."

I strongly agree with this, and now am trying to think of a subculture that positions themselves oppositionally to normies, and has a similar sense of superiority as bitcoiners en masse, but who are (unlike bitcoiners en masse) just in their assessment -- who really are that superior to everyone else, whose smugness is warranted.

None of the ones I can think of survive much scrutiny.

Like, there's a big keto contingent of researchers and scientists, later branching into carnivore, who believe they're right about everything, and have some compelling evidence that makes them feel smart and proud. Personal testimonials, etc. They think everyone else is so deluded! I used to be in this group.

But it's only a short jaunt over to the plant-based people where you find comparable stories of transformation complete with before-and-after photos, comparable (even superior) science, and comparable smugness. You choke on it.

The nature of human affairs is that neither group can acknowledge the merits in the other. They are memetically sealed. And how could they not be? Once a movement acquires enough energy, other ideas become threats with potential to upend the established power structures in the subculture in question, won through blood and battle. Most of the calories of this life stage are spent defending against transgression, or mounting an offense to bring the fight to the hated enemy.

Of course, the more they fight, the more each side is entrenched. So long as neither is annihilated, both thrive, after their fashion. Holy crusaders in each group grow prominent. They get elected to office or spin up their own podcasts and YouTube channels. Everyone gets to be somebody.

Maybe it's just the story of Kuhn's paradigms playing out, and the true heart of every subculture (e.g., proponents of the germ theory of infection; or heliocentrism; or anti-slavery; or bitcoin) eventually win out so thoroughly that people don't even consider alternative ideas to be thinkable thoughts; what remains is groups fighting around the edges of some conquered territory long after the meaningful battles have been won.

reply \ 65 sats \ 1 reply \ @Artilektt 14 May

We're gonna be colonizing the universe and still arguing over diet.

reply \ 27 sats \ 0 replies \ @BITCOIN 14 May

you just described the op return skirmish

reply \ 10 sats \ 0 replies \ @ek 14 May

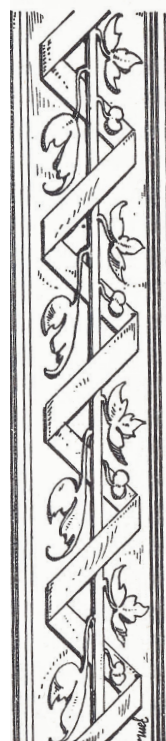
Cool, my posts are generating posts!

It's like my post had a baby, haha

CONSENSUS $\neq$ CONFLICT



corevsknots.info





CORE



CORE - CONTRIBUTORS

- ▲ Total Contributors (API): 346 WINT (+272)
- ▲ Active Contributors: 115 WINT (+16)
- ▲ Bus Factor: 21 WINT (+16)
- ▼ Gini Coefficient: 0.77 (0-1) (-0.11 (0-1))
- ▲ Org. Count (Email Domains): 42 WINT (+11)
- ▼ Org. Diversity (Shannon): 0.664 (0-1) (-0.041 (0-1))



KNOTS



KNOTS - CONTRIBUTORS

- ▼ Original Authors: 74 (-272)
- ▼ Active Contributors: 99 (-16)
- ▼ Bus Factor: 3 (-16)
- ▲ Gini Coefficient: 0.88 (0-1) WINT (+0.11 (0-1))
- ▼ Org. Count (Email Domains): 31 (-11)
- ▲ Org. Diversity (Shannon): 0.705 (0-1) WINT (+0.041 (0-1))

